

SKILLS GUIDE



Excellent communication skills and high levels of confidence to negotiate trading options.



Strong numerical skills to manipulate financial data when compiling and analyzing reports.



Strong computer skills for using computerized financial systems to conduct efficient financial trades.



In-depth knowledge and awareness of issues that might affect financial markets.



Attention to detail and the ability to react swiftly and decisively to market changes.

RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **INVESTMENT ANALYST** *see pp. 100–101*
- ▶ **ECONOMIST** *see pp. 108–109*
- ▶ **INVESTMENT BANK ACTUARY** Conducts research to assess the potential risks of investment decisions, such as buying or selling particular shares. Investment bank actuaries are among the most influential and best-paid professionals in the world of finance.
- ▶ **STOCKBROKER** Buys and sells stocks and other investments on behalf of businesses and individual clients, rather than for large financial institutions, taking a percentage of clients' fees.

PROPRIETARY TRADER

Working as an employee of a bank or other financial institution, a proprietary trader increases profits for an employer by using the company's money—rather than that of a client—to buy and sell on the financial markets.



SALES TRADER Works to create new business for banks by identifying and talking to potential clients, and liaising between the client and the traders who will handle the investments.



COMMODITY BROKER Buys and sells contracts for physical commodities—such as oil, gas, metals, and foods—on behalf of companies.



TRADER You will need to gain professional qualifications before you can perform all the functions of a trader. With experience, you can progress into specialized roles.



STRUCTURER Develops, models, and sets the pricing structure for sophisticated financial products, such as derivatives, the price of which may vary according to the value of a linked asset, such as a share.



QUANTITATIVE ANALYST (QUANT) A “quant” develops and runs complex mathematical formulae, or algorithms, that determine the prices of shares or other financial products and assess risks. Also identifies profitable trading opportunities.